

Axel Breens



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Seasoned ICT professional

Programme and Project Manager (certified) / People Manager / Business Development Manager

Versatile ICT professional with over 30 years of experience leading engagements, business analysis, and operational functions within diverse international organizations. Proven leader with a strong ability to align IT and technology initiatives with commercial objectives. Extensive expertise in PMO, programme and project management across both waterfall and agile methodologies, complemented by deep experience in technology integration and people management. Recognized for effective collaboration with cross-functional and multinational teams at all organizational levels, ensuring that operations consistently meet enterprise client requirements. Known for a proactive, motivated, and team-oriented approach that drives sustainable results.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

	TELENET	Senior ICT Programme Manager	3/2018 – Present
	ECONOCOM	Manager Operations Centre Infrastructure Programme Manager / PMO	10/2016 - 6/2017 (9 mos) 1/2016 - 10/2016 (10 mos)
	NETAPP	Professional Services Mgr Benelux and Nordics Engagement Manager Escalations Manager	7/2011 – 5/2015 (3 yrs 11 mos) 5/2007 – 7/2011 (4 yrs 3 mos) 5/2006 – 5/2007 (1 yr 1 mo)
	EMC BDG	Programme Manager	11/2003 – 1/2006 (2 yrs 3 mos)
	MSP	Coordinator of PM's / Project Manager	3/2002 – 11/2003 (1 yr 9 mos)
	CRONOS	Business Consultant / Project Manager	3/1999 – 3/2002 (3 yrs 1 mo)
	ALCATEL	Product Manager	11/1997 – 3/1999 (1 yr 5 mos)
	SIEMENS	Technical Project Leader / Software Designer	5/1992 – 11/1997 (5 yrs 7 mos)

CORE COMPETENCIES

PROGRAMME MANAGER / PROJECT MANAGER

- Managed the full lifecycle of large ICT and business programmes (CAPEX €100K – €2M) for national and international clients, applying both waterfall and agile methodologies. Ensured strong programme governance through strategic alignment, policy and framework development, structured reporting, decision-making processes and risk management. Acted as the primary liaison between Legal, Business, Architecture, Development, Testing, Release Management, Operational Readiness, TBO, Sales, Infrastructure and Operations teams, coordinating stakeholders across Belgium, India, the US and multiple European countries to secure alignment, clarity and timely delivery.
- Key Projects managed include:
 - Change Capability Cockpit - ADKAR, synchronize activities of Capability Owners and Change Agents
 - Nexus transition programme – replace incumbent partners Cognizant and Hays companies by Infosys and Netcracker (KT, reverse KT, shadowing, reverse shadowing).
 - Network Service Assurance initiative – Improve the customer experience and financials of the maintenance of Telenet's Hybrid Fibre Coax and Fibre network by introducing new tools based on available operational data (predictive maintenance).
 - Appointment Orchestration – streamline all appointments for onsite interventions of external partners (Unit-T, Wyre...), Telenet and the Customer.
 - Introduction of new Telenet product offerings to the market
 - Voice Pro – PABX functionality in the cloud for SOHO customers
 - In Home Connectivity 2.0 - use of Plume pods iso Power Boosters
 - Introduction of a new All Internet + DTV (2P) product
 - Fibre-to-the-Home programme (FTTH)
 - Regulatory projects
 - Prepare the request to regulate Telenet's 5G solution for BIPT
 - Introduction of the Data Act European Legislation
 - Manage all Lawful Intercept related projects
 - Netcracker 2021 contract – rework the current Netcracker contracts into a new Agile contract moving away from Waterfall Way of Working.
 - Introduction of new EECC regulatory requirements for Card Stop and Number Portability
 - Replacement of End Of Life / Out Of Support servers and operating systems thus reducing Telenet's overall exposure to risk and fraud.
 - IC2N programme – make our strategic partners Infosys and Cognizant land in the new Telenet Agile Way of Working ('TAWOW') moving away from waterfall WoW.
 - Popeye transition programme – Managed the transition of 85+ Digital and Data resources and 35+ legacy BSS / OSS applications of several incumbent partners to two main future partners Infosys and Cognizant. This programme aimed to save 33+ mio€ CAPEX over 5 years.
 - Dependencies on Commercial WholeSale ('DoC WHS') programme
 - Build part - make sure that the dependencies of the BASE legacy environment (Ericsson components BSCS / BCS / CVAS, Epiphany...) on the remaining BASE Retail environment are cleared and that a 'Chinese Wall' on the new inventories (Ninas / Dinoman) was implemented. Automation of the SIM Ordering process (towards and from Gemalto / Idemia). Migration of about 7 million IMSI's and MSISDN's to the new inventories.

- Decommissioning part - realizing synergies for about 70 (mostly) BASE legacy applications that are not needed anymore during and after the migration of Base Pre Paid, Post Paid and B2B customers to the new integrated Telenet / BASE IT stack ('Origin'). This programme realized 12 mio€ savings in TCO for the IT Transformation & Integration BU. Total CAPEX investment of 1.85 mio€.
- A high level overview of other cross company, cross technology projects that I managed can be found here → https://www.abrconsultancy.be/assets/doc/abresume_projects.pdf

PEOPLE MANAGER / PROFESSIONAL SERVICES MANAGER

- Directed teams of approximately 10 - 15 (internal and external) Architects, TAM's, Consultants, SW and HW Engineers who were active in the Build and Run phase of major projects of national and international customers across various industries.
- Supervised a team of 3 – 5 (internal and external) Project Managers who were engaged in various large new and ongoing ICT infrastructure projects for national and international customers.
- Evaluated operations for Professional Services team and drove annual strategic planning through gathering and analyzing feedback from staff, clients, partners and colleagues.
- Responsible for Hiring, Training, Firing, Communicating, Organizing, Controlling, Planning and Evaluating of above teams.
- Work in close relationships with the Enterprise Sales District Managers, BU managers, Service Delivery Managers, Incident Managers and Change Managers to understand the current business needs, issues and pipeline.
- Manage technical escalations, provide shadowing opportunities, ensured backlog was controlled.
- Key customers included were Fabricom, ISS, Base, Daikin, Goodyear, VMM, Magotteaux, Toyota, ING, Ministry of Defense, European Commission, European Parliament, European Court of Auditors, KBC Bank, UCB Pharmaceutical, RBS, Rossel, UZ Gent, ASML and ABN AMRO.
- Met or exceeded targets of \$3.0 million in annual service booking and revenue during tenure.
- Worked with NetApp partners to ensure joined customer successes, organized Partner Academies to uplift knowledge of their technical resources.

BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT MANAGER / ENGAGEMENT MANAGER

- Collaborated with Enterprise Account Managers to drive the positioning of NetApp Professional Services to major accounts throughout Benelux.
- Designed brand positioning strategy for corporate packages to enterprise clients, as well as created Benelux customized packages.
- Facilitated creation and presentations of Statement of Works, including prerequisites, tasks, timelines, deliverables, and acceptance criteria.
- Worked with NetApp partners to ensure joined customer successes through common engagements.
- Provided coaching for Project Managers and Professional Services teams during rollouts.
- Generated between 380K € and 670K € annually in Professional Services bookings and revenue.
- Served within NetApp Global EM / PM community as EMEA Geo Lead.
- Major clients included KPN Getronics, KBC Bank, Belgacom, TomTom, Mobistar, De Post, UZ Gent, FeDict, European institutions, and UCB.

OTHER COMPETENCIES

- Cross-functional collaboration, multicultural communication, technology integration, complex installation planning and staffing, performance metrics development, leadership and strategic vision.

CERTIFICATES



Certified ScrumMaster, Id: 000741796, Expired: 06 February 2021



Certified Scrum Product Owner, Id: 1010752, Expired: 06 February 2021



Certified SAFe 6 Agilist, Id: 28782527-6844, Expired: 26 April 2024

EDUCATION

Master in de Industriële Wetenschappen / Industrieel Ingenieur Elektronica (ing.)

Stedelijke Industriële Hogeschool Antwerpen, 1990, met onderscheiding

Industriële Wetenschappen, SISO Paardenmarkt Antwerpen

LANGUAGES

Dutch – Native proficiency (mother tongue), **English** – Full professional working proficiency (CEFR C1),
French – Professional working proficiency (CEFR B2), **German** – Professional working proficiency (CEFR B2)

VARIOUS

Driver's **license B**, Date of birth **07/12/1966**, Excellent command of **MS Office applications**, Very good knowledge of other IT-tools (**MS Project, SharePoint, Teams, Jira, Confluence...**)